

Photoshop Your Album

Let's take a look at how Photoshop Album eases the task of managing images.

STEP Importing images

1 The first thing you need to do is import images directly from a camera, a scanner or from your hard drive. To import images, click on Get Photos in the taskbar, and select the appropriate option from the drop-down box. You can import images as well as audio and video files. If you are importing from a camera or scanner, you will have to provide a destination folder and an image format. If you already have Adobe PhotoDeleuxe or Activeshare albums, you can import from them as well. To import these albums, go to **File > Get Photos** and choose PhotoDeleuxe Album or Activeshare Album. You can also customise the arrangement of images into Catalogs. Go to **File > Catalog > New Catalog**, to create a new catalogue. Thus, if your computer has many users, each user can catalogue their images separately.

STEP Tagging images

2 Once you have imported your images, you have to organise them. Without image management, this is a cumbersome task, as you can't have an image in two groups without putting them in both group folders, thus wasting disk space. With image management software, each image can be associated with one or more tags. To tag images, click on Organize in the taskbar—you will see a list of tags on the left. The tags also have sub-categories, for example, under People you will find Family and Friends. To add a tag to an image, click on an image, select the desired tag and click on Attach in the left pane. You can also drag and drop a tag onto an image. Do this for multiple images by selecting the images (using [Ctrl]) and dragging and dropping the tag, or by selecting Attach.

All tagged images are displayed as an icon on the bottom-right corner of the image. Hovering the mouse over this icon will show a tool tip with the tags added to that image. To remove tags, just right-click on an image and select Remove tag—you will see a list of tags assigned to that image. Select the ones you want to remove, and click OK. Two important tags are Favorites and Hidden. When you assign the Favorites tag, it is given precedence when searching. Similarly, when an image has the Hidden tag, it does not show up in the search results. To display hidden images, you have to select Hidden as well as your desired Search tag, when searching.

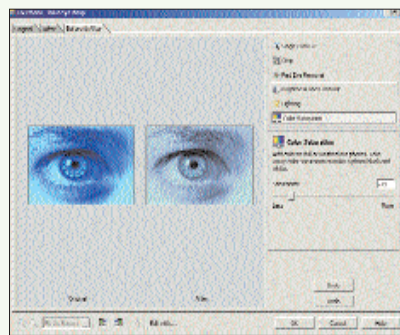
STEP Searching

3 There are many ways to perform a search in Photoshop Album. Above the thumbnails, you will see a 'Find' bar. You can

drag a tag to this bar to search for all files matching that tag. Dragging and dropping an image to this bar will search for all images similar to it. After a search is done, all images are sorted into two categories, viz, those that match and those that don't. To perform a search based on other parameters such as filename, media type, etc, you have to use the Find menu in the menu bar. From here, you can also search for images classified as 'Unknown date or time' and those with no associated tags. You can sort images based on fields such as date, folder location, and so on. The current field being used is displayed as the button name. Adjacent to that button, you can find buttons to change the layout of the screen, rotate the current image, show or hide the properties pane, etc.

STEP Image Editing

4 Using Photoshop Album, you can edit general errors in images. Select an image and click Fix in the taskbar. This brings up the Fix Photo window. On the right, you'll see different tools—Single Click Fix, Crop, Red Eye Removal, Brightness and Contrast, Light-



Photoshop Album offers basic editing features to improve on your images

ing and Color Saturation.

On the top of the window is a tab called 'Before & After'; select that tab to see a comparison of the image after a change is made to the original file. If you want to make some general improvements to the image, try the Single Click Fix first. There are four controls for it—Auto

Color, Auto Levels, Auto Contrast and Sharpen. Just click the button, and the program will adjust the image correspondingly. After you make the changes, the system will save the image in the format 'originalfilename_edited.filetype'—so 'digit.jpg' will be saved as 'digit_edited.jpg.'

STEP Archiving

5 Photoshop Album provides both backup and archiving features. You can restore the program to exactly the way it was, before taking the backup. This offers protection against any data loss or other anomalies. To create a backup, go to **File > Backup**, and choose

printing support, and is a good buy.

Preclick Photo Organizer 2.0

Preclick Photo Organizer has a pretty big list of features that it does not offer—it can't import images directly from a camera or scanner, and can't print images. The only editing you can do is 'Rotate', and you'll miss other features such as EXIF support, calendar, greeting card creation, etc.

To its credit, Photo Organizer has

one of the best interfaces. At the bottom of the screen is a list of all the thumbnails and above it is a bigger view of the selected image. Below the thumbnails, is the timeline—if you let the mouse hover over a line, you get the dates of images corresponding to that portion of the timeline. When the thumbnails are sorted according to folder or title, the timeline gives the name of the folder or title.

On the right is the information pane, where additional information about images is displayed. Each image can be

rated, with a maximum of four stars. Also, each image has an associated caption, subject, event and place tag. Below these are the Folder field, Find field, Rating field and Sort-by field. The Find field allows you to search for any detail about the image.

Photo Organizer is strongly recommended if you have a small collection of images, and need better features than what your OS offers. Its strength is its interface and ease of use, but it offers no additional features. The company also